Fedlex-JOLux documentation

Release 0.1

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Chapter 1

Abstraction Levels

In JOLux, all the different legislative resources are usually described through **three different levels of abstraction**. These levels are necessary to be able to reference legislative resources either depending on language and file format or not.

1.1 Work, Expression and Manifestation

jolux:Work

The owl:Class **jolux:Work** is a general abstraction for all the different legislative resources in JOLux. All the objects with type jolux:Work have additional types added to differentiate between the diverse legislative resources.

As jolux:Work is a general abstraction, the jolux:Work is *language and file-format agnostic*.

jolux:Expression

The owl:Class **jolux:Expression** is a *language specific* representation of a jolux:Work. The jolux:Expression is *file-format agnostic*.

jolux:Manifestation

The owl:Class **jolux:Manifestation** is a *file-format specific* representation of a jolux:Expression entity. So an jolux:Manifestation is a *language and file-format specific* representation of a jolux:Work.

So basically, jolux:Work, jolux:Expression and jolux:Manifestation always come together to form a rich representation of a legislative resource.

1.2 Object Properties

The vocabulary used to connect these abstraction levels is as following:

jolux:isRealizedBy

The object property **jolux:isRealizedBy** points from a jolux:Work to a jolux:Expression.

jolux:isEmbodiedBy

The object property **jolux:isEmbodiedBy** points from a jolux:Expression to a jolux:Manifestation.

jolux:isExemplifiedBy

The object property **jolux:isExemplifiedBy** points from a jolux:Manifestation to an object that represent the URL of the actual document.

The following figure shows the different abstraction levels and the object properties to connect them:

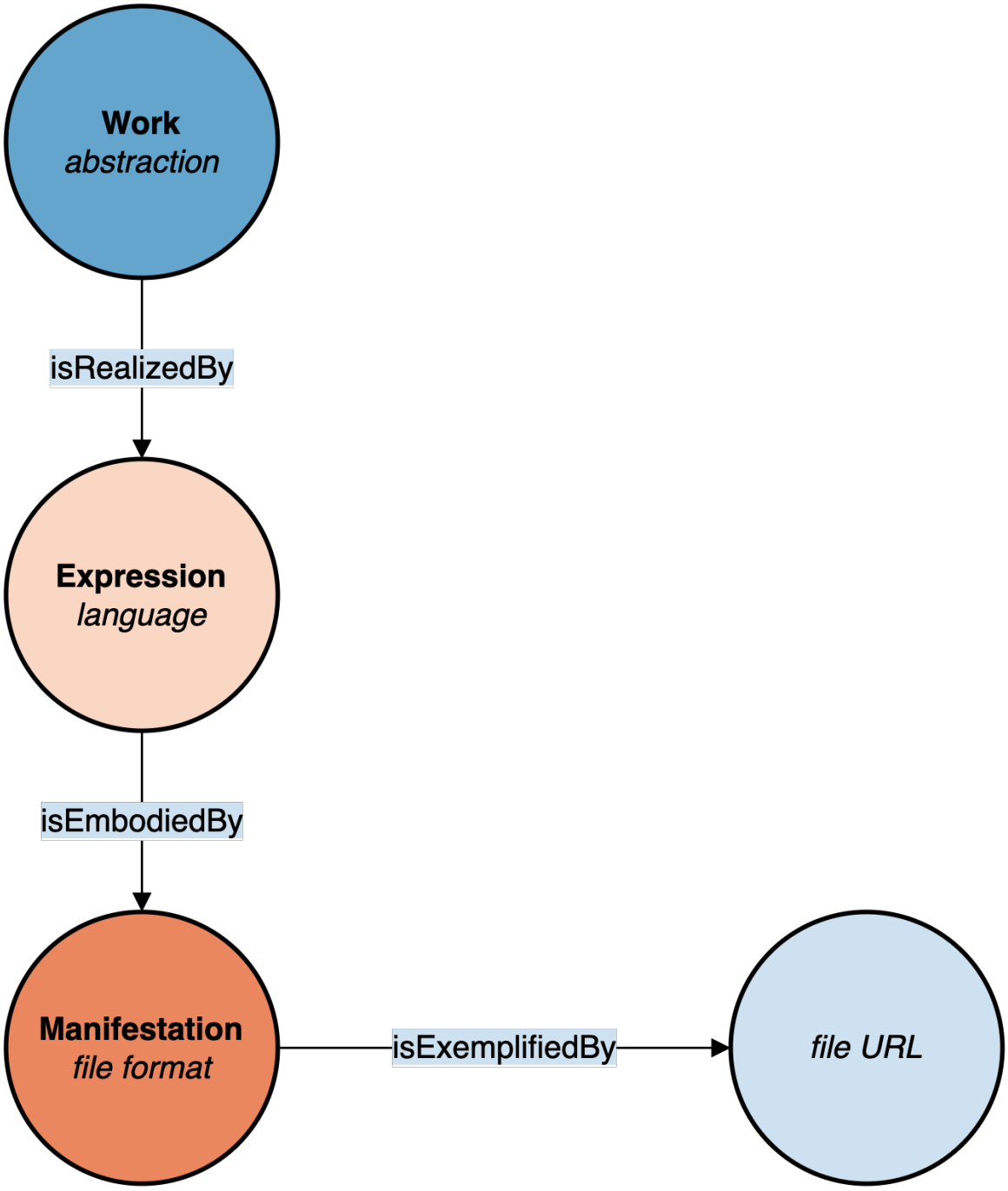

Figure 1.1. Relation between jolux:Work, jolux:Expression und jolux:Manifestation.

1.3 SPARQL Examples

The following question uses the above introduced abstraction levels to drill down from the URI of the Federal Constitution in the Official Compilation to the link of the PDF document in German:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {
    <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/oc/1999/404> jolux:isRealizedBy ?expression.
    ?expression jolux:language <http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority
/language/DEU>;
        jolux:isEmbodiedBy ?manifestation.
    ?manifestation jolux:format <http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority
/file-type/PDF>;
        jolux:isExemplifiedBy ?url.
}
```

Chapter 2

Official Compilation (OC)

The *Official Compilation (OC)* is according to the lexicon of parliamentary terms the compilation of primarily the federal constitution, federal acts and federal decrees.

This part explains all the important objects that build an entry in the Official Compilation and it does so with the help of the federal constitution as an example of an entry in the Official Compilation.

Hint for legal laypersons

Entries in the Official Compilation do not represent something like a current consolidated version of a legislative resource but are some kind of "building blocks" of an actual legislative resource. Updates to a legal text are published as "deltas" to already existing texts - much like an additional commit in software development.

In distinction from the Official Compilation, the current consolidated legislative resources are modelled in the Classified Compilation.

2.1 Example

Throughout this sub-page, the federal constitution is used as an example of an entry in the Official Compilation.

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/oc/1999/404
- URL: https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/oc/1999/404
- Metadata viewer

2.2 URI

The URI of an entry in the Official Compilation contains the following parts:

- Standard namespace and path: `https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/`
- the part `oc/` denotes the Official Compilation, meaning that this URI identifies something that is part of the Official Compilation of the federal law
- `YYYY/` is the year of the publication
- `ID` an identifier that has no specific meaning

2.3 General Structure

Every entry in the Official Compilation is of type jolux:Act.

jolux:Act

The owl:Class **jolux:Act** is used for entries in the Official Compilation and the Federal Gazette. It is of the same abstraction level as jolux:Work and all jolux:Act are also jolux:Work.

For jolux:Act, the additional abstraction levels jolux:Expression and jolux:Manifestation are also available for all entries.

The following figure shows the general structure of an entry in the Official Compilation:

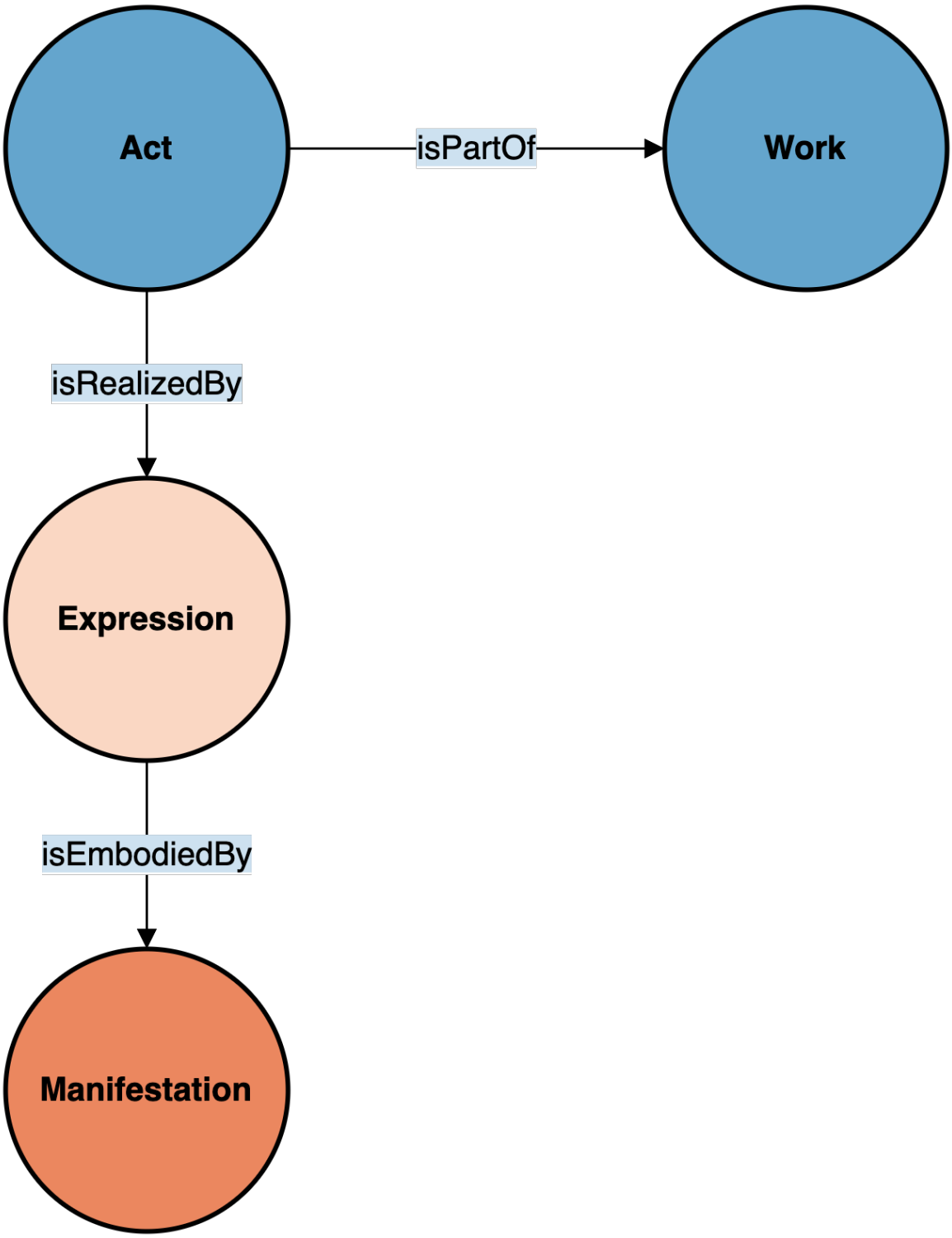

Figure 2.1. General structure of an entry in the Official Compilation.

As the jolux:Act is a very abstract representation of a legislative resource, there is e.g. no title of the law attached to the jolux:Act because this is something language specific and therefore added to the jolux:Expression of the jolux:Act.

As the Official Compilation is released in a weekly bulletin, all jolux:Act are part of such a bulletin via

jolux:isPartOf:

jolux:isPartOf

The object property **jolux:isPartOf** is used to connect a jolux:Act to the weekly bulletin that it is part of.

2.4 Datatype Properties

- jolux:publicationDate
- jolux:dateEntryInForce
- jolux:dateDocument

2.5 Object Properties

Object properties that point to a vocabulary entry:

- jolux:processType
- jolux:typeDocument
- jolux:classifiedByTaxonomyEntry
- jolux:legalRessourceGenre
- jolux:responsibilityOf

Object properties that point to an individual:

- jolux:isRealizedBy
- jolux:isPartOf

2.6 SPARQL Examples

The following SPARQL query shows all the different jolux:Expression for the federal constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?expression WHERE {
    <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/oc/1999/404> jolux:isRealizedBy ?expression.
}
```

The following SPARQL query shows all the different jolux:Manifestation for the federal constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?manifestation WHERE {
    <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/oc/1999/404> jolux:isRealizedBy ?expression.
    ?expression jolux:isEmbodiedBy ?manifestation.
}
```

The following SPARQL query shows all the different jolux:Act that have the legal genre "Basic legislation" and are not yet in force.

```
PREFIX xsd: <http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?act ?date WHERE {
```

```
    ?act jolux:legalResourceGenre <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary
/legal-resource-genre/100>;
         jolux:dateEntryInForce ?date.
  FILTER(?date > xsd:date(NOW()))
}
```

Chapter 3

Classified Compilation (CC)

The *Classified Compilation (CC)* (also known as Systematic Compilation) is according to the lexicon of parliamentary terms a regularly updated and revised collection of the legislative resources of the Official Compilation arranged under subject headings.

An important aspect of the Classified Compilation is the classification of the entries according to a legal taxonomy. A deeper explanation of the Classified Compilation is also available in German /French/Italian.

This part explains all the important objects that build an entry in the Classified Compilation and it does so with the help of the federal constitution as an example of an entry in the Classified Compilation.

Hint for legal laypersons

Entries in the Classified Compilation are consolidations of entries in the Official Compilation. The main reason for having a Classified Compilation is a better usability of the legislative resources because the Classified Compilation represents the current state of a legislative resource.

It is important to realize that the Classified Compilation is not legally binding, the source of the "true law" is always the Official Compilation.

3.1 Example

Throughout this sub-page, the federal constitution is used as an example of an entry in the Classified Compilation.

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404
- URL: https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404
- Metadata viewer

3.2 URI

The URI of an entry in the Classified Compilation contains the following parts:

- Standard namespace and path: `https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/`
- the part `cc/` denotes the Classified Compilation, meaning that this URI identifies something that is part of the Classified Compilation of the federal law
- `YYYY/` is the year of the publication
- `ID` an identifier that has no specific meaning

3.3 General Structure

Every entry in the Classified Compilation is of type jolux:ConsolidationAbstract.

jolux:ConsolidationAbstract

The owl:Class **jolux:ConsolidationAbstract** is used for entries in the Classified Compilation.

It is a consolidation because it consolidates different entries from the Official Compilation into a single document that shows the current state. The term *abstract* is not so much meant as a summary but as an abstraction.

A jolux:ConsolidationAbstract has a jolux:Expression attached for representing the title and abbreviation in different languages of this consolidation because this does not change. But there are no jolux:-Manifestation these only exist for jolux:Consolidation.

jolux:Consolidation

The owl:Class **jolux:Consolidation** is used for versions that represent a jolux:ConsolidationAbstract at a specific time. It is of the same abstraction level as jolux:Work and all jolux:Consolidation are also jolux:Work.

The different jolux:Consolidation are no "deltas" of the changes but always the complete state a the specific point in time.

For jolux:Consolidation, the additional abstraction levels jolux:Expression and jolux:Manifestation are also available for all entries.

The connection between jolux:Consolidation and jolux:ConsolidationAbstract is made with jolux:isMemberOf.

jolux:isMemberOf

The object property **jolux:isMemberOf** is used to connect a jolux:Consolidation to a jolux:ConsolidationAbstract. It is also used to connect the weekly bulletins of the Official Compilation to the yearly collection.

Each jolux:ConsolidationAbstract is based on an jolux:Act through jolux:basicAct.

jolux:basicAct

The object property **jolux:basicAct** is used to connect a jolux:ConsolidationAbstract to a jolux:Act. The connected act is the first version of the consolidation.

The following figure shows the general structure of an entry in the Classified Compilation:

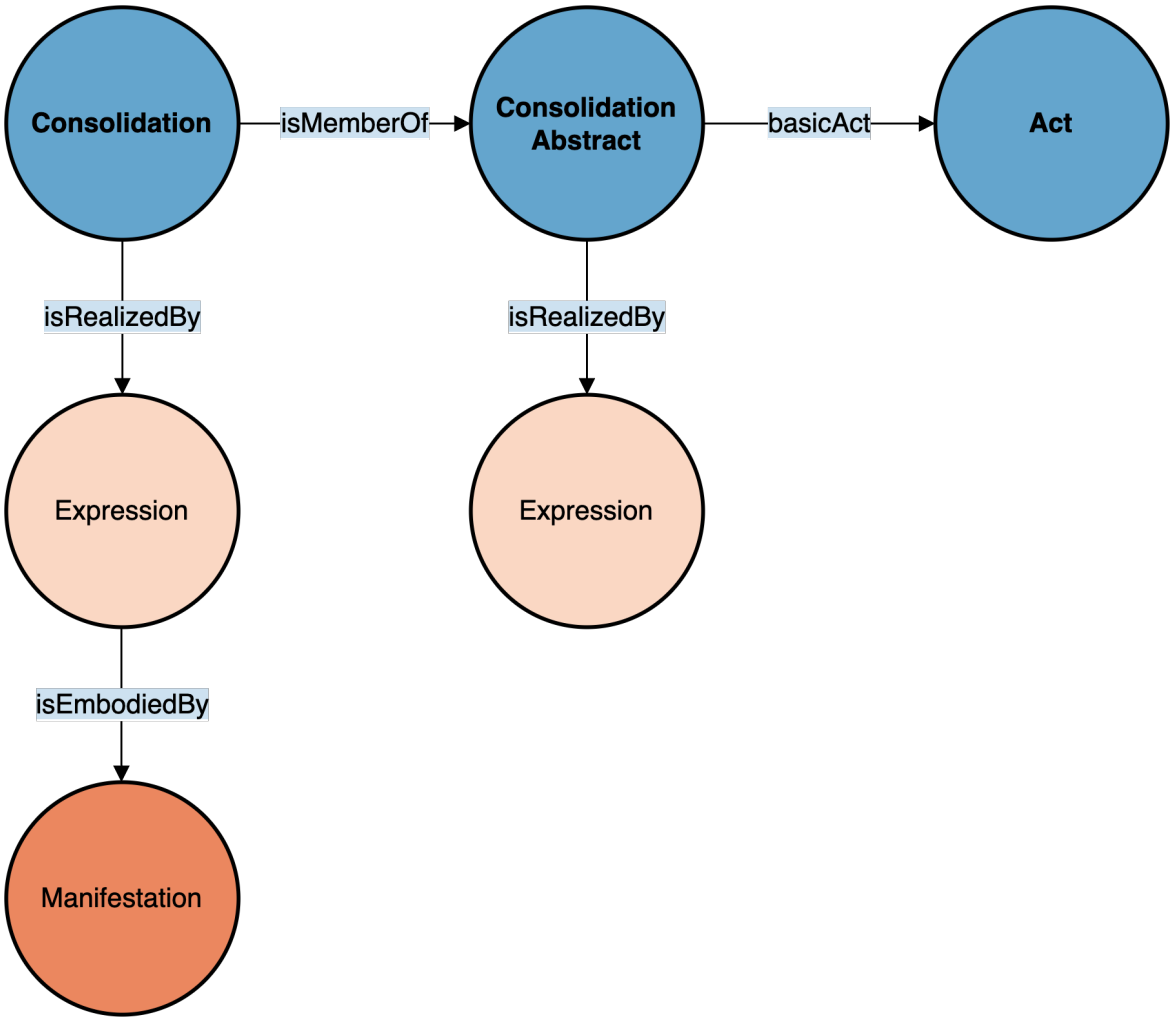

Figure 3.1. General structure of an entry in the Classified Compilation.

3.4 Legal Taxonomy

As the name Classified Compilation suggests, there is a classification scheme that sorts the entries in the Classified Compilation according to a legal taxonomy. This taxonomy is hierarchical and formulated as vocabulary.

3.5 Datatype Properties

3.5.1 jolux:ConsolidationAbstract

- jolux:dateEntryInForce
- jolux:dateDocument

3.5.2 jolux:Consolidation

- jolux:publicationDate
- jolux:dateApplicability

3.6 Object Properties

3.6.1 jolux:ConsolidationAbstract

Object properties that point to a vocabulary entry:

- jolux:typeDocument
- jolux:classifiedByTaxonomyEntry
- jolux:inForceStatus

Object properties that point to an individual:

- jolux:basicAct
- jolux:isRealizedBy

3.6.2 jolux:Consolidation

Object properties that point to an individual:

- jolux:isMemberOf
- jolux:isRealizedBy

3.7 SPARQL Examples

The following SPARQL query shows all the different versions of the federal constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {
    ?consolidation jolux:isMemberOf <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404>.
}
```

The following SPARQL query gives the PDF link to the latest version of the constitution in English through a chain to jolux:Consolidation, jolux:Expression and jolux:Manifestation:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {
    ?work jolux:isMemberOf <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404>;
                  jolux:dateApplicability ?date;
                  jolux:isRealizedBy ?expression.
  ?expression jolux:language <http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority
/language/ENG>;
                 jolux:isEmbodiedBy ?manifestation.
  ?manifestation jolux:format <http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority
/file-type/PDF>;
                   jolux:isExemplifiedBy ?url.
} ORDER BY DESC(?date)
LIMIT 1
```

Chapter 4

Impacts

Impacts is what connect entries in the Classified Compilation and Official Compilation. The entries in the Classified Compilation are consolidations of entries in the **Official Compilation**. This means that entries in the Official Compilation usually have an impact on entries in the Classified Compilation.

Impacts are modelled as jolux:LegalResourceImpact.

jolux:LegalResourceImpact

The owl:Class **jolux:LegalResourceImpact** is used to build an entry in the Classified Compilation out of different entries in the Official Compilation. Entries in the Official Compilation have impacts on entries in in the Classified Compilation. The jolux:LegalResourceImpact has two main predicates. jolux:impactFromLegalResource points to the source of the impact and jolux:impactToLegalResource points to the impacted resource.

4.1 Example

Throughout this sub-page, the following jolux:LegalResourceImpact is used as an example.

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/oc/2015/104/legal-analysis/LegalResourceImpact/1
- URL: No URL available for jolux:LegalResourceImpact
- Metadata viewer

4.2 URI

The URI of a jolux:LegalResourceImpact contains the following parts:

- it starts with the URI of the entry in the Official Compilation that is the source for the impact.
- `/legal-analysis/LegalResourceImpact/` denotes all impacts
- `ID` an identifier that has no specific meaning

4.3 General Structure

The following figure shows the connection between entries in the Official Compilation and Classified Compilation trough jolux:LegalResourceImpact:

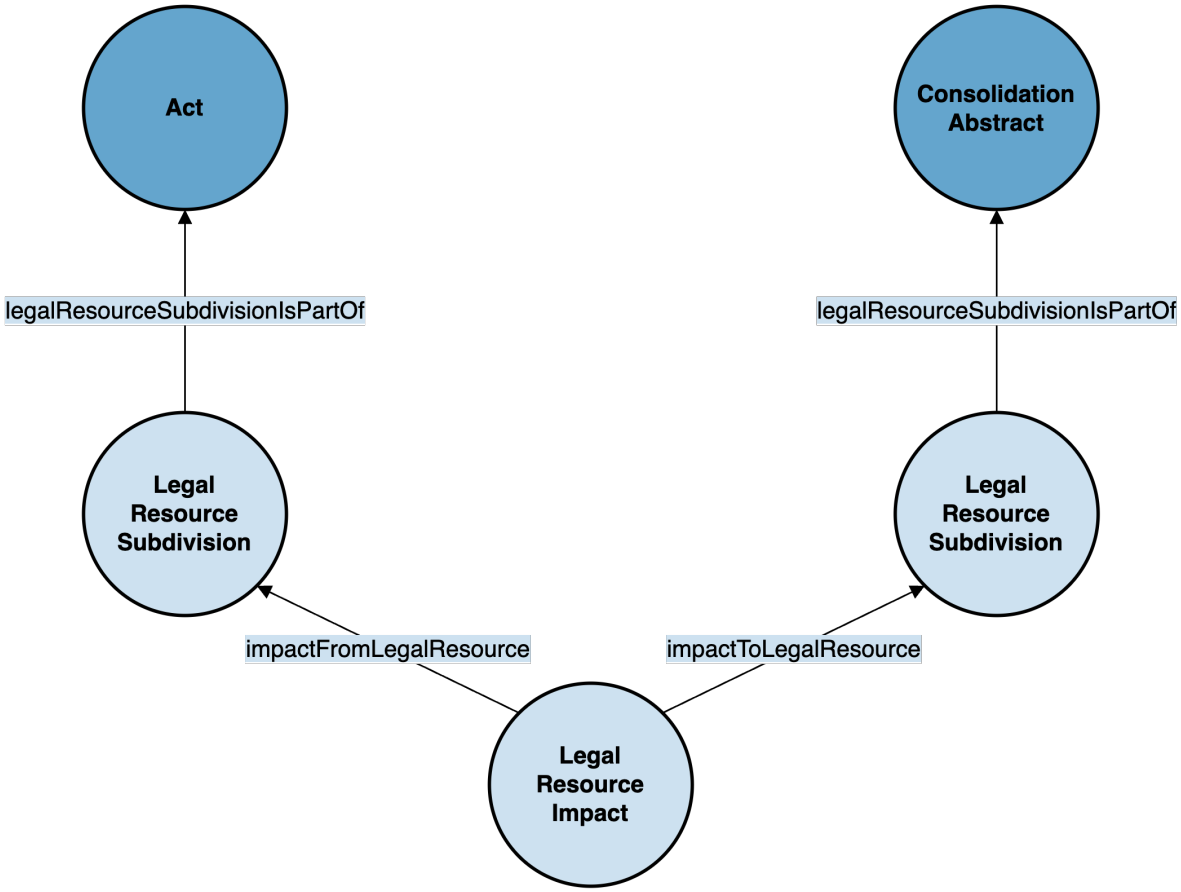

Figure 4.1. Connection between entries in the Official Compilation and the Classified Compilation through impacts.

As it is shown in the figure above, the connection between jolux:LegalResourceImpact and the entries in the Official Compilation and Classified Compilation is not direct but through jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision. The predicates used to connect the source and the target of the impact are jolux:impactFromLegalResource and jolux:impactToLegalResource.

jolux:impactFromLegalResource

The object predicate **jolux:impactFromLegalResource** is used to connect a jolux:LegalResourceImpact to a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision as a source of the impact.

jolux:impactToLegalResource

The object predicate **jolux:impactToLegalResource** is used to connect a jolux:LegalResourceImpact to a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision as a target of the impact.

jolux:impactConsolidatedBy

The object predicate **jolux:impactConsolidatedBy** is used to connect a jolux:LegalResourceImpact to a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision that is part of the corresponding jolux:Consolidation.

4.4 Datatype Properties

- jolux:legalResourceImpactHasDateEntryInForce

4.5 Object Properties

Object properties that point to a vocabulary entry:

- jolux:legalResourceImpactHasType

Object properties that point to an individual:

- jolux:impactFromLegalResource
- jolux:impactToLegalResource
- jolux:impactConsolidatedBy

4.6 SPARQL Examples

The following query shows all the entries in the Official Compilation, that have an impact on the federal constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT DISTINCT ?act ?date WHERE {
  ?impact jolux:impactFromLegalResource/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf
 ?act;
    jolux:impactToLegalResource/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf <https:
//fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404>.
  ?act jolux:dateEntryInForce ?date.
} ORDER BY ?date
```

Chapter 5

Subdivisions

To structure a legislative resource further, jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision is used:

jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision

The class **jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision** is used to structure each legislative resource into units: Article (basic unit) and elements above and below this in the hierarchy, as well as annexes and other elements. The concrete unit is attached by using jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionType.

5.1 Example

Throughout this sub-page, the following jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision is used as an example.

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404/text
- URL: No URL available for jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision
- Metadata viewer

5.2 URI

The URI of a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision contains the following parts:

- it starts with the URI of the entry in the Official or Consolidated Compilation
- `/type` denotes the type of the subdivision

5.3 General Structure

The following figure shows the general structure of a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision:

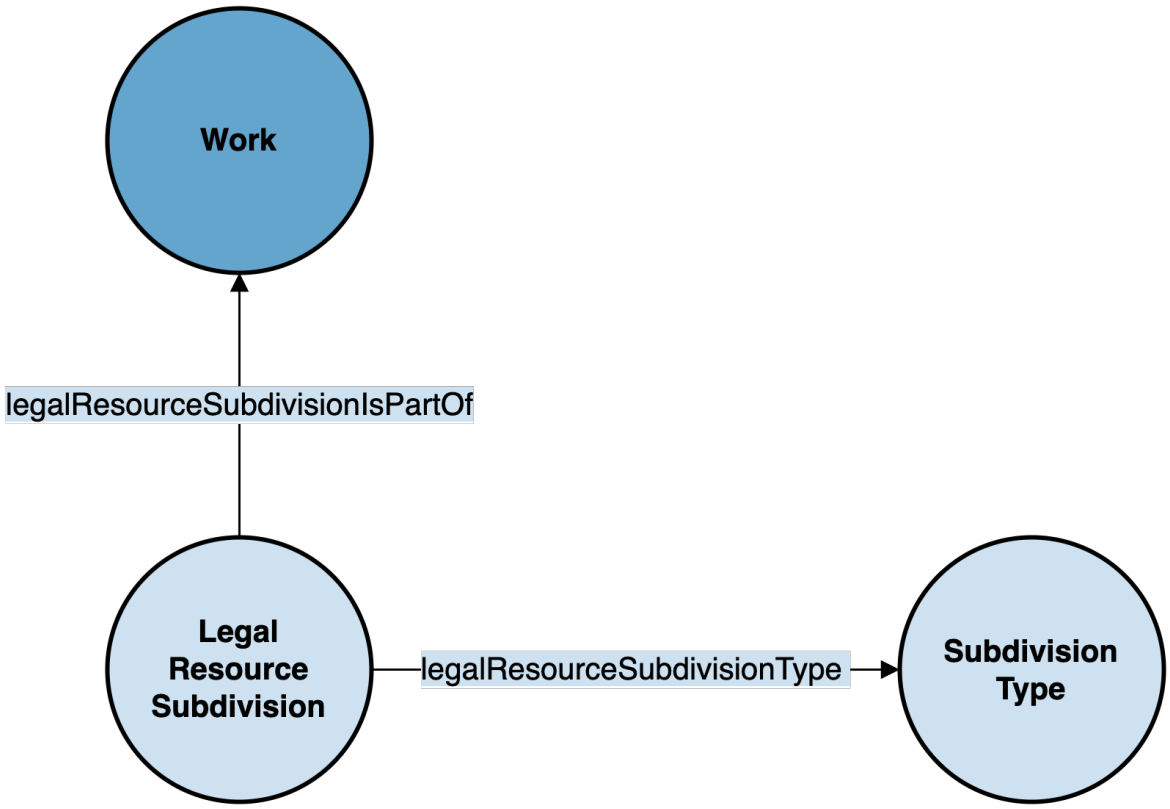

Figure 5.1. General structure of a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision.

The jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision is bound to a jolux:Work through jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf.

---

jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf

The property **jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf** is used to connect a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision with its jolux:Work.

The jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision have a type from the subdivision types vocabulary.

Hint for legal laypersons

With help of jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision, it is possible to divide a legislative resource also on the level of the individual articles. But this is not systematically done (yet). The single articles are only modelled when it is necessary for a jolux:LegalResourceImpact (see Section 5.5 below).

5.4 Object Properties

Object properties that point to a vocabulary entry:

- jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionType

Object properties that point to an individual:

- jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf

5.5 SPARQL Examples

The following query shows all the subdivisions of the federal constitution in the Classified Compilation with its types:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {
  ?subdivison jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch
/eli/cc/1999/404>;
    jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionType ?type.
}
```

Chapter 6

Chronology

The term **chronology** is used to list all legislative resources that are relevant for a specific entry in the Classified Compilation.

There are different mechanisms how legislative resources can be relevant for the chronology:

6.1 Draft

In creating a new legislative resource, a jolux:Draft is created.

jolux:Draft

A **jolux:Draft** is used to bundle all the activities and documents during the process of drafting a new legislative resource.

The following figure shows the general structure of a jolux:Draft:

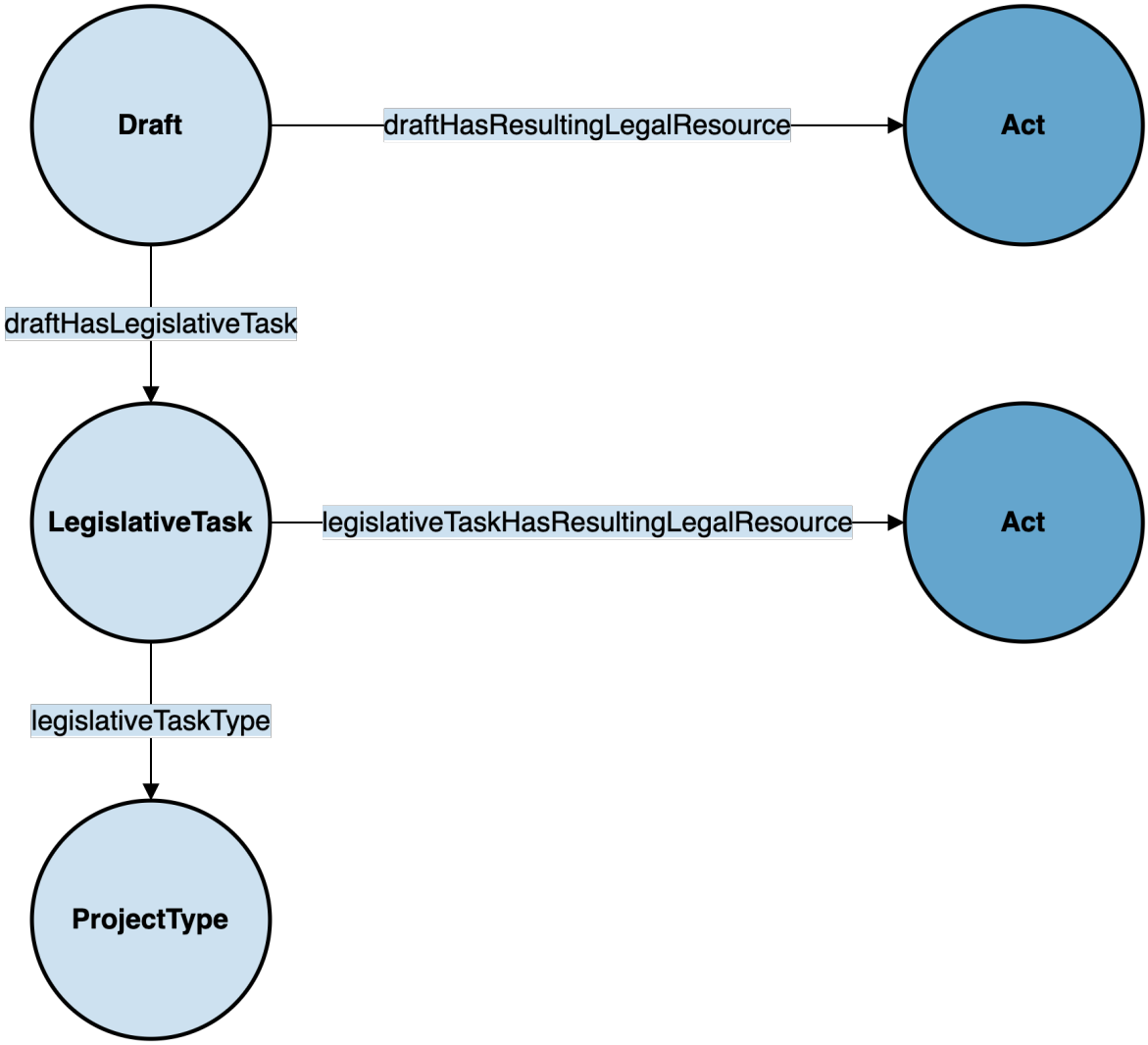

Figure 6.1. General structure of a jolux:Draft.

The following SPARQL query shows all the jolux:Act that werde involved in drafting the Federal Constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?act WHERE {
    ?draft jolux:hasResultingLegalResource <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/oc
/1999/404>;
        jolux:draftHasLegislativeTask ?task.
    ?task jolux:legislativeTaskHasResultingLegalResource ?act.
}
```

6.2 Impact

If new legislative resources are created that have an impact on existing ones, they are modelled as Figure 4.1.

The following SPARQL query shows all the jolux:Act that have an impact on the Federal Constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT DISTINCT ?act WHERE {
    ?impact jolux:impactFromLegalResource/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf
 ?act;
        jolux:impactToLegalResource/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf <https:
//fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404>.
}
```

Chapter 7

Changes

The term **changes** is used to list all changes to a specific entry in the Classified Compilation on the level of single articles.

Changes are extracted from Figure 4.1. There are two methods used to depict the concerned articles depending on the date of the change.

7.1 Older Changes

The concerned articles of older changes are modelled via a jolux:impactToLegalResourceComment:

jolux:impactToLegalResourceComment

The datatype property **jolux:impactToLegalResourceComment** lists the impacted articles on the legislative resource from the Figure 4.1 as `rdf:langString`.

7.2 Newer Changes

For newer changes, the impacted articles are modelled as jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision.

7.3 SPARQL Examples

The following sparql query lists all the impacts on the Federal Constitution. The concerned articles are either given in the jolux:impactToLegalResourceComment or modelled as jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {

    ?subdivision jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf <https:
//fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404>.
    ?impact jolux:impactToLegalResource ?subdivision;
        jolux:impactFromLegalResource/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf ?act;
        jolux:legalResourceImpactHasType ?type.

    OPTIONAL {
        ?impact jolux:impactToLegalResourceComment ?comment.
    }

    FILTER (!BOUND(?comment) || lang(?comment) = "de")
}
```

Chapter 8

Citations

Legal texts often refer other legislative resources in the form of citations. In JOLux, citations are modelled as jolux:Citation.

jolux:Citation

A **jolux:Citation** is used to model citations between legislative resources.

The following figure shows the general structure of a citation:

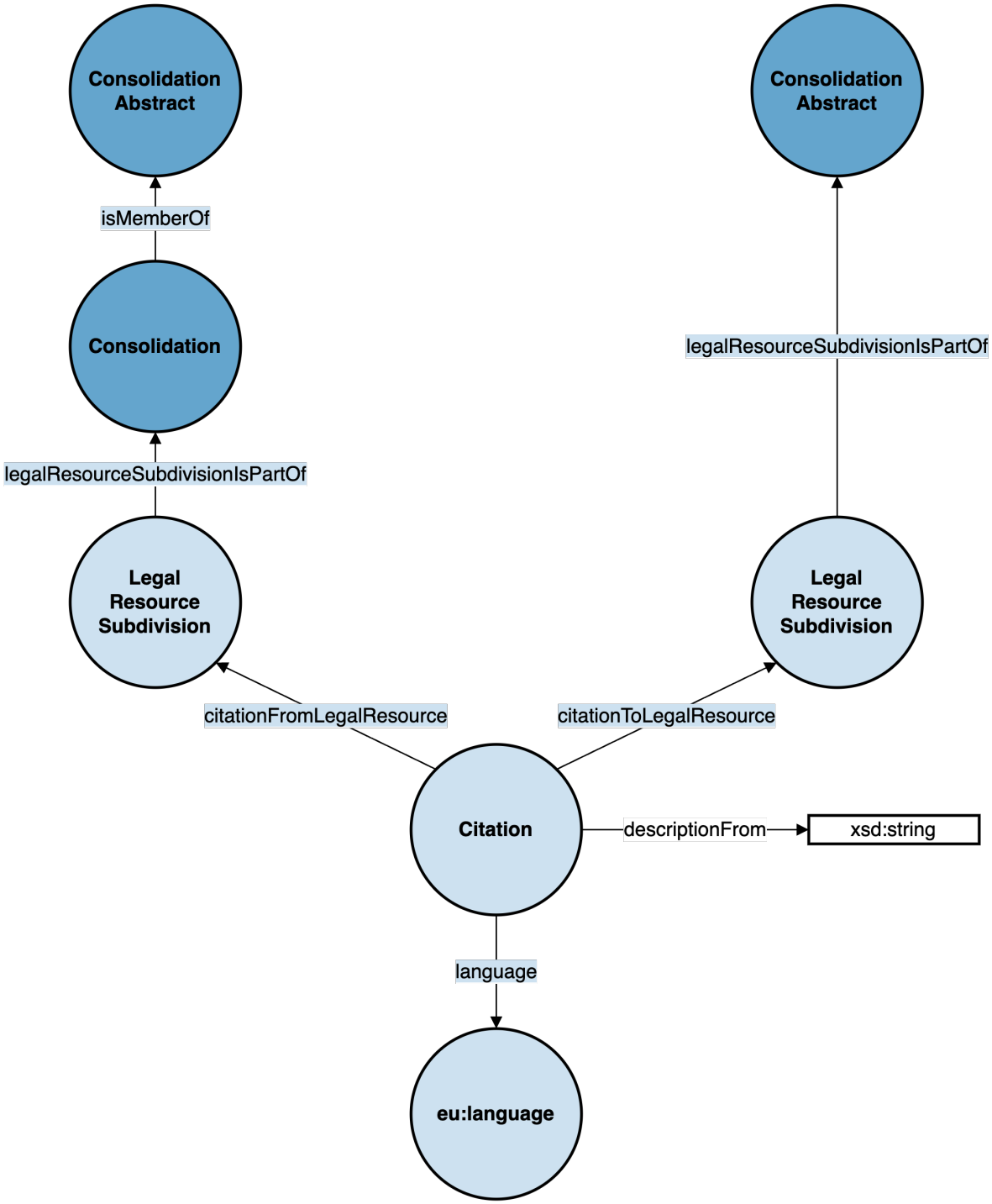

Figure 8.1. General structure of a citation.

The citations for an entry in the Classified Compilation can be shown with the following URL (example for the Federal Constitution): https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404/de/quotes. These pages are only available in German, French, and Italian.

8.1 From and To

A citation *from* means the citing resource whereas *to* means the cited resource. So if a legislative resource cites the Federal Constitution, the citation goes *from* this resource *to* the Federal Constitution.

jolux:citationFromLegalResource

The object property **jolux:citationFromLegalResource** is used to connect a jolux:Citation to a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision that is the **citing** document.

jolux:citationToLegalResource

The object property **jolux:citationToLegalResource** is used to connect a jolux:Citation to a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision that is the **cited** document.

8.2 SPARQL Example

The following SPARQL query shows all the jolux:ConsolidationAbstract with its German titles that cite the Federal Constitution:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {
    ?citation jolux:citationToLegalResource/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf
 <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404>;
                                          jolux:citationFromLegalResource
/jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf/jolux:isMemberOf
 ?consolidationAbstractFrom.
  ?citation jolux:descriptionFrom ?descriptionFrom;
            jolux:language <http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority
/language/DEU>.
  ?consolidationAbstractFrom jolux:isRealizedBy ?expressionFrom.
  ?expressionFrom jolux:language <http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority
/language/DEU>;
               jolux:title ?titleFrom.
}
```

Chapter 9

International Treaties

Under construction

This sub-page is under heavy construction…

According to Termdat, an international treaty is an "international agreement concluded between states in written form and governed by international law, whether embodied in a single instrument or in two or more related instruments and whatever its particular designation".

Hint for legal laypersons

International Treaties are sometimes approbated into the Official Compilation.

9.1 Example

Throughout this sub-page, the following treaty process is used as an example.

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/treaty/2024/0311
- URL: https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/treaty/2024/0311/de
- Metadata viewer

9.2 URI

The URI of a treaty process contains the following parts:

- Standard namespace and path: `https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/`
- the part `treaty/` shows that it is about a treaty
- `YYYY/` is the year of the publication
- `ID` an identifier that has no specific meaning

9.3 General Structure

Treaties evolve around a jolux:TreatyProcess.

jolux:TreatyProcess

The owl:Class **jolux:TreatyProcess** is used group the important elements of an international treaty.

The following figure shows the general structure of a treaty process:

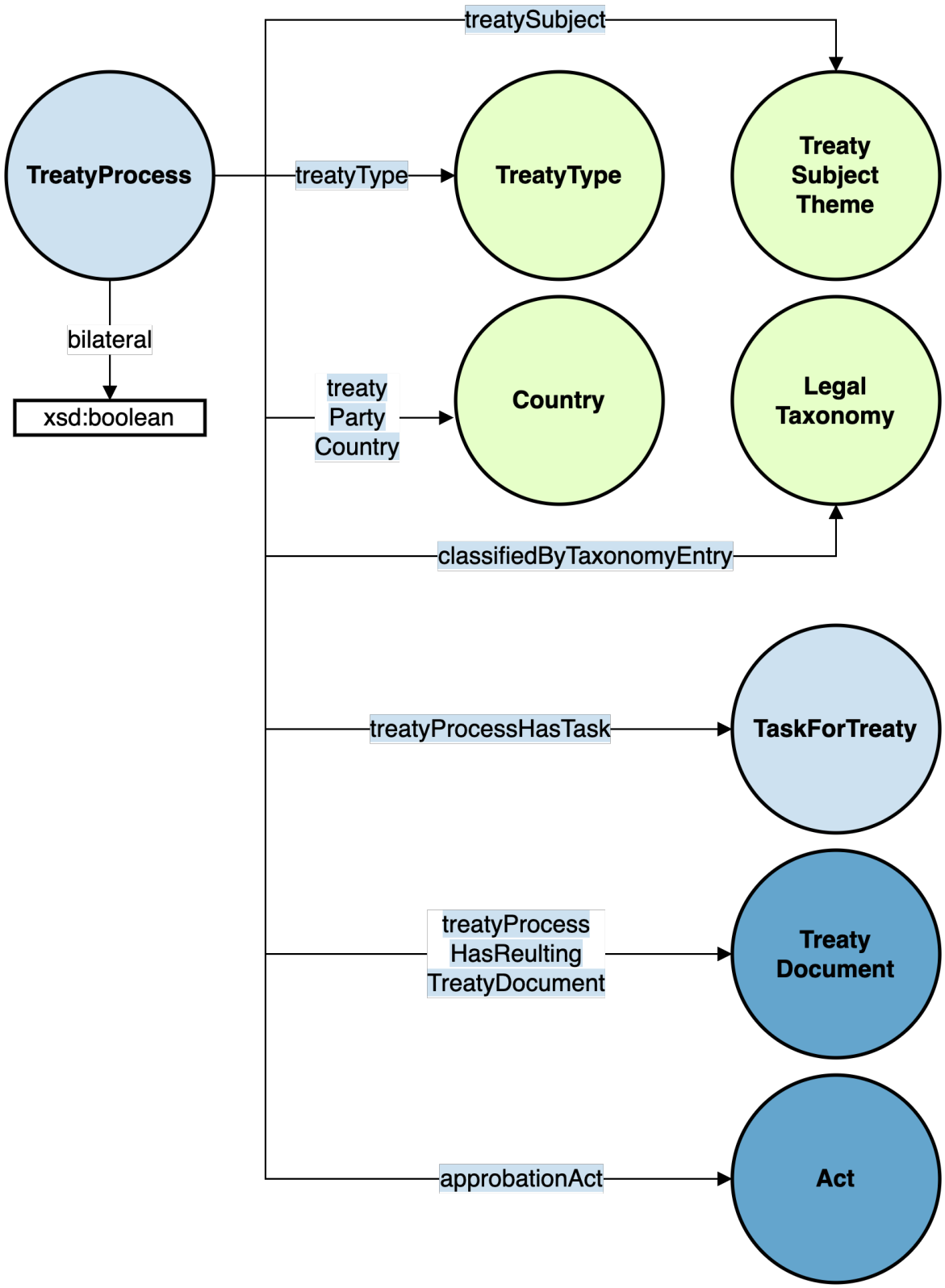

Figure 9.1. General structure of a treaty process.

Entities of class jolux:TreatyProcess have different jolux:TaskForTreaty added.

jolux:TaskForTreaty

The owl:Class **jolux:TaskForTreaty** is used as class for all the tasks that are necessary for concluding a treaty.

The possible types of tasks are given in the section Section 9.4.

The result of an international treaty is always a jolux:TreatyDocument.

jolux:TreatyDocument

The owl:Class **jolux:TreatyDocument** is used for the resulting treaty of the jolux:TreatyProcess.

9.4 SPARQL Example

The following SPARQL query shows all the different classes that are used on a jolux:TaskForTreaty to further segment these tasks:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT DISTINCT ?class WHERE {
  ?task a jolux:TaskForTreaty;
        a ?class.
  FILTER(?class != <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#Event>)
}
```

The class jolux:Event is filtered because all jolux:TaskForTreaty are also jolux:Event.

Chapter 10

Vocabularies

In RDF, a vocabulary is a **set of predefined terms**, that is used to describe resources. These terms are defined in a way that allows them to be used **consistently across different datasets**. In the case of JOLux, vocabularies are specifically used only on the object position of RDF triples.

Fedlex defines and makes use of multiple vocabularies. This sub-page lists an overview and the main vocabularies and its associated properties that are used in describing the legislative resources.

10.1 Available Vocabularies

As all vocabularies are modelled as having the class skos:ConceptScheme, the metadata viewer can give all the vocabularies as incoming relations to skos:ConceptScheme and therefore serves as an overview on all available vocabularies.

In addition, the following SPARQL query shows all vocabularies with its name in English, German and French. The name is either `dcterms:title` where available and otherwise `rdfs:label` or empty if there is neither:

```
PREFIX rdfs: <http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#>
PREFIX dcterms: <http://purl.org/dc/terms/>
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
SELECT DISTINCT ?vocabulary ?name_en ?name_de ?name_fr WHERE {
    ?vocabulary a skos:ConceptScheme.

  # English title
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary dcterms:title ?title_en .
    FILTER(LANG(?title_en) = "en")
  }

  # German title
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary dcterms:title ?title_de .
    FILTER(LANG(?title_de) = "de")
  }

  # French title
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary dcterms:title ?title_fr .
    FILTER(LANG(?title_fr) = "fr")
  }

  # English label
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary rdfs:label ?label_en .
    FILTER(LANG(?label_en) = "en")
```

```
  }

  # German label
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary rdfs:label ?label_de .
    FILTER(LANG(?label_de) = "de")
  }

  # French label
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary rdfs:label ?label_fr .
    FILTER(LANG(?label_fr) = "fr")
  }

  # Use ?title if available and otherwise ?label
  BIND(COALESCE(?title_en, ?label_en) AS ?name_en)
  BIND(COALESCE(?title_de, ?label_de) AS ?name_de)
  BIND(COALESCE(?title_fr, ?label_fr) AS ?name_fr)
}
```

10.2 Hierarchical Vocabularies

Some vocabularies are modelled as hierarchy or taxonomy of entries. The following SPARQL query lists all vocabularies that use a hierarchy:

```
PREFIX rdfs: <http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#>
PREFIX dcterms: <http://purl.org/dc/terms/>
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
SELECT DISTINCT ?vocabulary ?name_en WHERE {
    ?vocabulary a skos:ConceptScheme;
                skos:hasTopConcept ?top_concept.
  ?top_concept skos:narrower ?narrow.

  # English title
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary dcterms:title ?title_en .
    FILTER(LANG(?title_en) = "en")
  }

  # English label
  OPTIONAL {
    ?vocabulary rdfs:label ?label_en .
    FILTER(LANG(?label_en) = "en")
  }

  # Use ?title if available and otherwise ?label
  BIND(COALESCE(?title_en, ?label_en) AS ?name_en)
}
```

10.3 Act Types

Act Types

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/legal-resource-genre
- Description: The **act types** vocabulary is used to classify the type of a jolux:Act.
- Predicates: jolux:legalResourceGenre

- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary
/legal-resource-genre>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

10.4 Enforcement Status

Enforcement Status

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/enforcement-status
- Description: The **enforcement status** vocabulary is used to classify the type of a jolux:ConsolidationAbstract.
- Predicates: jolux:inForceStatus
- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary
/enforcement-status>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

10.5 Impact Types

Impact Types

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/impact-type
- Description: The **impact types** vocabulary is used to classify the type of a jolux:LegalResourceImpact.
- Predicates: jolux:legalResourceImpactHasType
- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
```

```
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/impact-type>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

10.6 Legal Institution

Legal Institution

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/legal-institution
- Description: The **legal institution** vocabulary is used to add the responsibility of an institution for jolux:Act.
- Predicates: jolux:responsibilityOf
- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary
/legal-institution>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

As this is a hierarchical vocabulary, the following SPARQL query shows the hierarchy of the entries:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>

SELECT (GROUP_CONCAT(CONCAT(STR(?endpoint_level), ": ", STR(?endpoint_label));
 separator = " <---- ") AS ?hierarchy) WHERE {
    SELECT * WHERE {
        ?endpoint skos:narrower* ?intermediate;
            skos:prefLabel ?endpoint_label.
        FILTER(lang(?endpoint_label) = "de")
        {
            SELECT ?endpoint (COUNT(?endpoint) as ?endpoint_level) WHERE {
                BIND (<https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/legal-institution>
 as ?root)
                ?root skos:hasTopConcept/skos:narrower* ?intermediate.
                ?intermediate skos:narrower* ?endpoint.
            } GROUP BY ?endpoint ORDER BY ?endpoint_level
        }
    } ORDER BY ?intermediate ?endpoint_level
} GROUP BY ?intermediate ORDER BY ?hierarchy
```

10.7 Legal Taxonomy

Legal Taxonomy

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/legal-taxonomy
- Description: The **legal taxonomy** vocabulary is used to classify entries of a jolux:ConsolidationAbstract.
- Predicates: jolux:classifiedByTaxonomyEntry
- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/legal-taxonomy>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

As this is a hierarchical vocabulary, the following SPARQL query shows the hierarchy of the entries:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>

SELECT (GROUP_CONCAT(CONCAT(STR(?endpoint_level), ": ", STR(?endpoint_label));
 separator = " <---- ") AS ?hierarchy) WHERE {
    SELECT * WHERE {
        ?endpoint skos:narrower* ?intermediate;
            skos:prefLabel ?endpoint_label.
        FILTER(lang(?endpoint_label) = "de")
        {
            SELECT ?endpoint (COUNT(?endpoint) as ?endpoint_level) WHERE {
                BIND (<https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/legal-taxonomy> as
 ?root)
                ?root skos:hasTopConcept/skos:narrower* ?intermediate.
                ?intermediate skos:narrower* ?endpoint.
            } GROUP BY ?endpoint ORDER BY ?endpoint_level
        }
    } ORDER BY ?intermediate ?endpoint_level
} GROUP BY ?intermediate ORDER BY ?hierarchy
```

As this is a very important vocabulary, there are also two special webpages that show these hierarchical legal taxonomy entries. One for Swiss law and one for international law.

10.8 Procedure Types

Procedure Types

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/type-procedure
- Description: The **procedure types** vocabulary is used to classify the type of a jolux:Act.
- Predicates: jolux:processType

- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/type-procedure>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

10.9 Subdivision Types

Subdivision Types

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/subdivision-type
- Description: The **subdivision types** vocabulary is used to classify the type of a jolux:LegalResourceSubdivision.
- Predicates: jolux:legalResourceSubdivisionType
- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary
/subdivision-type>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

As this is a hierarchical vocabulary, the following SPARQL query shows the hierarchy of the entries:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>

SELECT (GROUP_CONCAT(CONCAT(STR(?endpoint_level), ": ", STR(?endpoint_label));
 separator = " <---- ") AS ?hierarchy) WHERE {
    SELECT * WHERE {
        ?endpoint skos:narrower* ?intermediate;
            skos:prefLabel ?endpoint_label.
        FILTER(lang(?endpoint_label) = "de")
        {
            SELECT ?endpoint (COUNT(?endpoint) as ?endpoint_level) WHERE {
                BIND (<https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/consultation-stage>
 as ?root)
                ?root skos:hasTopConcept/skos:narrower* ?intermediate.
                ?intermediate skos:narrower* ?endpoint.
            } GROUP BY ?endpoint ORDER BY ?endpoint_level
        }
    } ORDER BY ?intermediate ?endpoint_level
} GROUP BY ?intermediate ORDER BY ?hierarchy
```

10.10 Text Types

Text Types

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/resource-type
- Description: The **text types** vocabulary is used to classify the text type of a jolux:Work.
- Predicates: jolux:typeDocument, jolux:historicalTypeDocument
- Metadata viewer

The following SPARQL query shows all the entries of this vocabulary with its labels:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT ?term ?label WHERE {
    ?term skos:inScheme <https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/resource-type>;
        skos:prefLabel ?label.
    FILTER NOT EXISTS {?term a skos:Collection}
    FILTER (lang(?label) = "en")
}
```

As this is a hierarchical vocabulary, the following SPARQL query shows the hierarchy of the entries:

```
PREFIX skos: <http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#>

SELECT (GROUP_CONCAT(CONCAT(STR(?endpoint_level), ": ", STR(?endpoint_label));
 separator = " <---- ") AS ?hierarchy) WHERE {
    SELECT * WHERE {
        ?endpoint skos:narrower* ?intermediate;
            skos:prefLabel ?endpoint_label.
        FILTER(lang(?endpoint_label) = "de")
        {
            SELECT ?endpoint (COUNT(?endpoint) as ?endpoint_level) WHERE {
                BIND (<https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/vocabulary/resource-type> as
 ?root)
                ?root skos:hasTopConcept/skos:narrower* ?intermediate.
                ?intermediate skos:narrower* ?endpoint.
            } GROUP BY ?endpoint ORDER BY ?endpoint_level
        }
    } ORDER BY ?intermediate ?endpoint_level
} GROUP BY ?intermediate ORDER BY ?hierarchy
```

Chapter 11

Dates

Concerning legislation, there are a number of dates that are important during the legislative process. All the date literals are modelled with datatype `xsd:date`.

11.1 Dates relevant to jolux:Work

On the abstraction level of jolux:Work, the following dates are important:

jolux:publicationDate

The property jolux:publicationDate denotes the date of first publication in one of the collections. If the same document is republished, this date does not change: it is always the date of the initial publication that is decisive.

On the other hand, for consolidations, several publication dates may exist: each new publication of the file generates a new date.

jolux:dateEntryInForce

The property jolux:dateEntryInForce denotes the date on which the law takes legal effect.

jolux:dateNoLongerInForce

The property jolux:dateNoLongerInForce denotes the date on which the law stops to have a legal effect.

jolux:dateDocument

The jolux:dateDocument property is used to indicate the decision date of an act, or the date on which the document was adopted.

For bills, where there is no formal adoption date, the Document Date is used as the reference date.

11.2 Dates relevant to jolux:Consolidation

jolux:dateApplicability

The property jolux:dateApplicability denotes the date from which a jolux:Consolidation takes effect.

jolux:dateEndApplicability

The property jolux:dateEndApplicability denotes the date from which a jolux:Consolidation or a jolux:ConsolidationAbstract no longer takes effect.

11.3 Dates relevant to jolux:LegalResourceImpact

jolux:legalResourceImpactHasDateEntryInForce

The property jolux:legalResourceImpactHasDateEntryInForce denotes the effective date of an jolux:LegalResourceImpact.

Chapter 12

Reference

The following terms are all to be understood as prefixed with `jolux:`, so the full URI for e.g. Act is: `http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#Act`. The terms are sorted alphabetically.

12.1 JOLux Classes

- Act
- Citation
- Consolidation
- ConsolidationAbstract
- Draft
- Expression
- LegalResourceImpact
- LegalResourceSubdivision
- Manifestation
- Work

12.2 JOLux Datatype Properties

Dates:

- dateApplicability
- dateDocument
- dateEndApplicability
- dateEntryInForce
- dateNoLongerInForce
- legalResourceImpactHasDateEntryInForce
- publicationDate

Others:

- impactToLegalResourceComment

12.3 JOLux Object Properties

Link to vocabulary entries:

- classifiedByTaxonomyEntry
- historicalTypeDocument
- inForceStatus
- legalRessourceGenre
- legalResourceImpactHasType
- legalResourceSubdivisionType
- processType
- responsibilityOf
- typeDocument

Link to individuals:

- basicAct
- citationFromLegalResource
- citationToLegalResource
- impactConsolidatedBy
- impactFromLegalResource
- impactToLegalResource
- isEmbodiedBy
- isExemplifiedBy
- isMemberOf
- isPartOf
- isRealizedBy
- legalResourceSubdivisionIsPartOf

12.4 Concepts

- Abstraction Levels
- Changes
- Chronology
- Citations
- Classified Compilation (CC)
- Dates
- Impacts
- Official Compilation (OC)
- Subdivisions
- Vocabularies

This introduction explains some key terms to understand the scope of its content and describes the structure of the webpage and how to use it.

Chapter 13

Fedlex

The Swiss federal government operates the **Fedlex** platform to publish the **federal law**. This platform provides a website as frontend with easy navigable functions. For some cases, it is beneficial to work directly with the raw data that is also the basis for the frontend website. This raw data is available in RDF format through a SPARQL GUI and a SPARQL endpoint at `https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/sparqlendpoint`.

Chapter 14

JOLux Ontology

The raw data of the Fedlex platform in RDF is modelled according to the **JOLux ontology**. This ontology is used for describing **legislative resources and their relationships**.

JOLux is based on recent developments in bibliographical description, adapting the FRBR model (Functional requirements for Bibliographic Records, developed by the IFLA) in order to describe legislative resources.

This website's goal is to document the JOLux ontology and help users to find their way into the RDF data of the Fedlex platform and make the most use of it. It is not the basis for the JOLux ontology meaning that there is no completeness of all the aspects of JOLux in this documentation. So this website can not be used to model data according to the JOLux ontology but rather to understand data that is already modelled with help of JOLux. If complete insight into the JOLux ontology is necessary, it can be downloaded as Turtle file for further investigation.

Chapter 15

How to Use this Website

This website has sub-pages for all the important Section 12.4. A concept is loosely defined an important element of the JOLux ontology. These sub-pages describe the concept in prose. Additional call-out boxes give short definition of JOLux and other terms (see the example below for ontology). These boxes are all linked in the reference.

Ontology

An ontology is a set of precise descriptive statements about some part of the world (usually referred to as the domain of interest or the subject matter of the ontology). Precise descriptions satisfy several purposes: most notably, they prevent misunderstandings in human communication and they ensure that software behaves in a uniform, predictable way and works well with other software. Source

The visual representation of parts of the JOLux ontology on this website is loosely based on the VOWL project. In addition, multiple colors represent the different abstraction levels of JOLux.

The following figure shows the elements of graphical representation of JOLux in this documentation using an example of a jolux:Act:

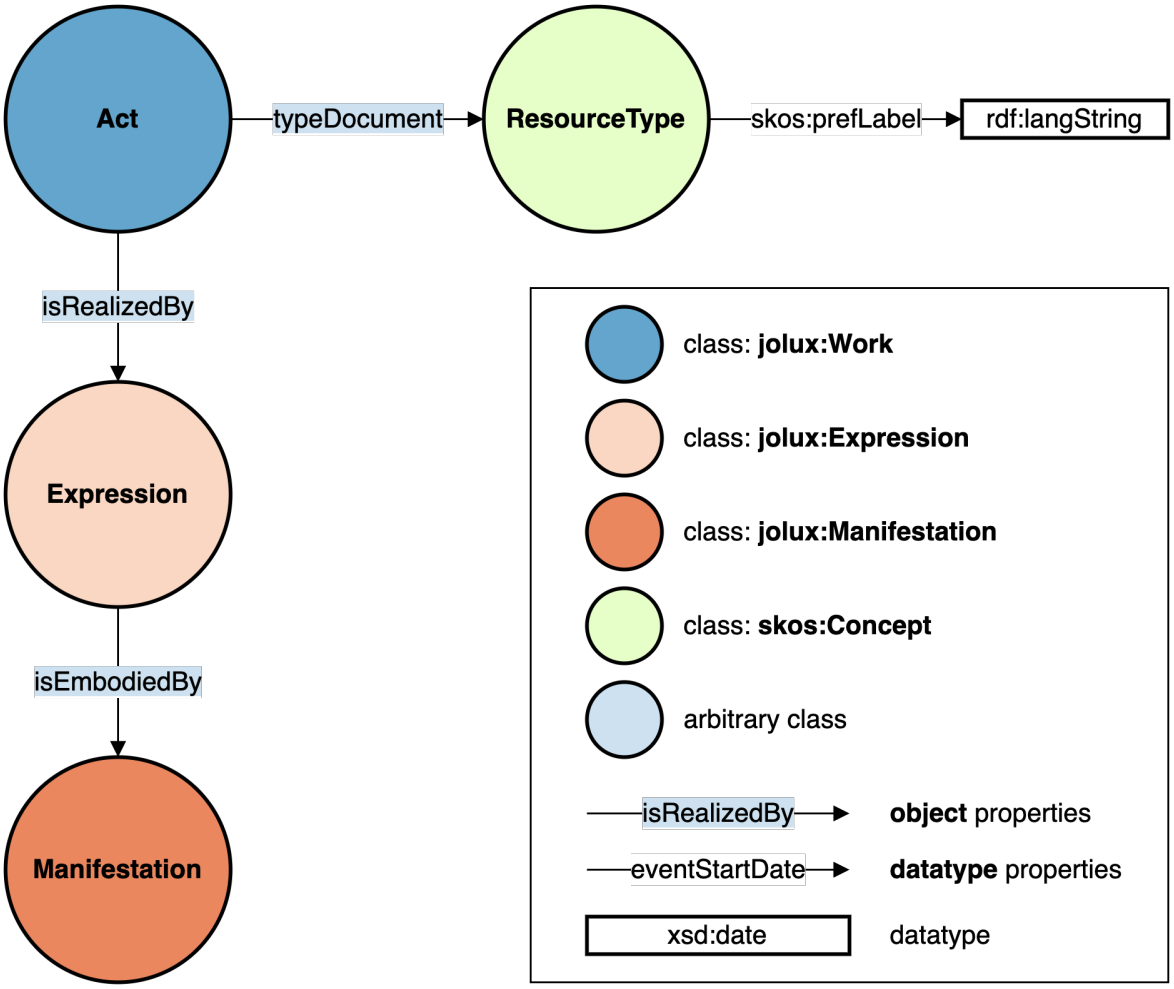

Figure 15.1. Graphical representation of JOLux ontology elements.

The figure above can be read as: Some object of type jolux:Act is connected to an object of type jolux:-Expression via predicate jolux:isRealizedBy. So the single bubbles do not represent concrete objects but signal class memberships.

Chapter 16

Website as PDF

This website is also available as PDF.

Chapter 17

SPARQL Queries

Throughout this webpage, there are examples of SPARQL queries given. The idea is, that these are real queries that can be executed on the Fedlex SPARQL GUI to get real up to date results. To do so, below every SPARQL example query, there is a "Execute Query" button that transfers the corresponding query into the SPARQL GUI and executes it to show the tabular result. As the source code of these queries is also given, the user should be encouraged to modify these queries directly in the SPARQL GUI or use it programmatically to their own needs.

The following SPARQL query shows this method by giving the 10 newest published jolux:Act that are available:

```
PREFIX jolux: <http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#>
SELECT * WHERE {
    ?act a jolux:Act;
         jolux:publicationDate ?date.
} ORDER BY DESC(?date)
LIMIT 10
```

Chapter 18

Fedlex URI and URL

All URI of Fedlex raw data resources start with: `https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli` whereas `eli` is an abbreviation for European Legislation Identifier.

These URI can be found on the website of Fedlex through a search. The raw data URI is not the URL shown in the browser address field but can be copied by clicking on the chain icon. If an an URI is put into the browser address field, there is an automatic redirection to the webpage URL that displays the corresponding resource.

Examples for the federal constitution in the Classified Compilation:

- URI: https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404
- URL: https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404

The easiest way to have a graph like representation of a Fedlex URI (and not a redirection to the URL) is to put it into the metadata viewer of the Fedlex platform. Links to the metadata viewer with prefilled URI can also be programmatically created via URL parameter `value` with the desired URI:

```
https://fedlex.data.admin.ch/en-CH/metadata?value=https:
//fedlex.data.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404
```

The URLs given in this documentation are given without language identifier. In reality, there is no such URL as https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404 but only https://www.fedlex.admin.ch/eli/cc/1999/404/en or with other language identifiers like `de`, `fr`, `it` or `rm` in the end. But there is a redirection mechanism in place that automatically redirects to the correct language URL according to browser settings if no language identifier is given.

Chapter 19

Namespaces Declarations

The following namespaces are used throughout this documentation:

PREFIX	URI
jolux	http://data.legilux.public.lu/resource/ontology/jolux#
schema	http://schema.org/
skos	http://www.w3.org/2004/02/skos/core#
dcterm	http://purl.org/dc/terms/
xsd	http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema#
rdfs	http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#
rdf	http://www.w3.org/1999/02/22-rdf-syntax-ns#
owl	http://www.w3.org/2002/07/owl#
eu	http://publications.europa.eu/resource/authority/